CAMPO DEL CIELO (Meteorite) — ‘Valley of the heaven’

‘Campo del cielo’ refers to the group of Iron meteorites found in the provinces of Argentina.

Characteristics: ‘Campo del cielo’ is an iron meteorite group (IAB). It is composed of iron(~94.6%), nickel (~5.4%) and other trace elements such as (Co,Ga,P,Ge,Ir). These usually have a metallic and shiny appearance when polished and are strongly magnetic. Their hardness is quite high but they are prone to rusting on Earth. Its fragments range from a few grams to giant masses weighing several tons.

Occurrence/formation: The fall is estimated to have occurred about ~4000 years ago on ‘Radiocarbon’ and ‘Cosmogenic nuclide’ dating, while the age of the Iron group meteorites is usually estimated to be ~(4.2-4.5) Gyr and as the samples exhibit ‘Neumann band formation’, produced when the crystal accommodate heavy stress without breaking (Heavy impacts were common in early solar system) hence causing twinning in crystals which we observe as bands, and as the meteorite is rich in Iron and Nickel. This indicates that their origin can be traced to an asteroid or planetesimals core from the early solar system.

Fun-fact: Campo del cielo (“Valley/field of heaven”) is a Spanish name given by Spanish colonists in 1576. They heard indigenous people (such as ’Abipon’ and ‘Moqoit’) describing the objects as (Pieces of heaven) hence the name. Their tradition reflects the long-standing recognition of these unusual Sky-stones in the region.